

Parks Board Meeting February 17, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wRQVnQPMLp8
Publication Date	2026-02-18T11:57:27Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Summary: Muncie Park and Recreation Board

Meeting Date: Tuesday, February 17, 2026

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

Omitted (No statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Brad Marshall called the regular meeting of the Muncie Park and Recreation Board to order on Tuesday, February 17, 2026, at **00:00:09**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Ashley Wright, Mark, Shannon Powers, and Brad Marshall (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** None noted in the roll call.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance (00:00:12).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the January meeting were presented with no discussion or revisions and approved by voice vote (00:00:47).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:14 Superintendent Report: Park Updates & Staffing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent of Parks, alongside newly introduced Assistant Superintendent Chris Meadows (who has 19 years of departmental experience).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Malone reported that unsafe wooden shelters at Alshshire, McCullum, and Ball Ball Park were successfully removed by internal staff. They will be replaced by new metal shelters. Staff also completed general shop cleaning, painting, and inventorying.
 - Park-specific updates included:
 - *West Side Park:* Playground renovation led by Adam Leech; baseball diamond renovation underway (scoreboard, lights, power, and dugout updates planned); basketball court funding process moving forward with DNR approval.
 - *Riverview Park:* Play zone and restrooms are complete; mulch pricing is being reviewed for the playground; kickball field maintenance will continue for daycares.
 - *Heekin Park:* Lights planned for both basketball courts; restroom door security issues are being addressed with vendors (Heekin remains open year-round for cabin rentals); 9th and Hackley park sign quotes being gathered; tennis court neighborhood association discussions ongoing.
 - *Alshshire Park:* Playground mulch and equipment needs noted; shelter removed with metal replacement incoming; basketball court targeted for early spring 2026 renovation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board action taken.
- **00:09:21 Summer Programming & Grant Applications**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone & Shannon Powers.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed upcoming summer programming and budget constraints. Meetings were held with the Ball Foundation regarding potential funding support for summer programs, though a final funding decision is not expected until mid-May, which may require on-the-spot cancellation calls if funding falls short. Additional recreation grants are also being pursued.
 - Signups for the Muncie Teen Internship Program (running June 3rd through July 17th with applications open until March 13th) are currently live on Facebook, with

- roughly 70 applicants so far for about 50 available spots (down from 110 last year).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board vote required for internal recreation programs.
- **00:16:55 Presentation: Haltermann Village Neighborhood Association Phase 4**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** JP Hall (President) and Pete Gipman (Board Member).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The presenters provided a multi-year update on the transformation of the former Haltermann Swim Club property (abandoned in 2017) into a vibrant public park. Over the past seven years, the 501(c)(3) association has raised nearly \$200,000 in private money, leveraging approximately \$300,000 in public funds (totaling around \$500,000). Completed improvements include playground equipment, trails, trees, pickleball courts, and 10 new benches. Phase 4 initiatives include exterior and interior improvements to the former concession building/restroom area and a collaborative public art project with Professor Rod Underwood's architecture studio steel program. The project is entirely self-funded and reliant on volunteer labor.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None outside of the formal presentation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote. The board officially voted to go on record supporting the Haltermann Neighborhood Association to move forward with Phase 4 and continue their partnership with the parks department.
- **00:31:23 Prairie Creek Reservoir General Manager Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Taylor Beard, new General Manager.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** General Manager Taylor Beard delivered her first report, noting that interviews for the administrative coordinator role were completed, with onboarding starting March 1st. Projects underway include quoting lumber from Carter for dock repairs, sanding/staining walkboards, counting and organizing tires for a recycling grant (coordinated with Shannon), and installing a key card system and camera at the campground bathroom with Security Pros. Campground extensions are being processed (roughly half the campers remain). Future plans include exploring dedicated bank fishing areas, upgrading the boat launch area (patching holes, restriping, adding bins/lighting/grip tape), repairing the departmental pontoon boat, and launching a weekly or monthly newsletter to improve public transparency.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal board action taken.
- **00:36:09 Old Business: YMCA Pool Operations & Flatland Projects Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Marshall / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Y Pool Operations:* Ongoing discussions with the YMCA are scheduled for the week to finalize operations for the upcoming year.
 - *Flatland Updates:* Received an email update covering several ongoing projects:

- Tillson Pond: Planning phases continue with the city and DNR; site walkthrough scheduled for March, with construction targeted for fall. Low maintenance and site tidiness will be handled by the park staff.
- West Side Basketball Courts: Assistance ongoing.
- Heikin Park: MLK Dream Team Walk of Fame signage scheduled for spring installation alongside Ziggler Foundation grant collaboration.
- Prairie Creek Reservoir Trail Phase 3: 30% through the design phase, coordinating with the city, county, and sail club; construction planned for late in the year.
- RFQ for the upcoming 5-year plan is currently out, with submissions due in a couple of weeks.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational updates; no formal board votes taken.
Note: Trash pickup responsibilities across city parks have officially transitioned to the sanitation department.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:43:24 Aaron and Steve (Gus Macker Basketball Tournament Representatives):**
 - Presented a formal update on bringing the Gus Macker basketball tournament back to Muncie.
 - Noted they recently returned from a conference and are currently processing paperwork.
 - Discussed equipment needs and coordination challenges, including requests for 6 three-rise bleachers and 22 eight-foot tables (noting that 6-foot tables do not fit their table covers and the board noted cabin rentals may limit table availability).
 - Addressed sound systems, stating they have secured a portable PA from North Side Church of God (Pastor Matt) and plan to coordinate with Southside High School's athletic director regarding additional sound capabilities.
 - Highlighted that 70% of teams are youth teams, projecting approximately 200 teams and 10,000 attendees, resulting in an estimated \$3M to \$5M economic impact. They are also coordinating with Destination Muncie and noted that Gus Macker was previously included as a \$50,000 line item in the previous five-year plan.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Recognition of new staff members (Assistant Superintendent Chris Meadows and Prairie Creek GM Taylor Beard).
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second at **00:49:24**.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-18 06:17:22 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.